

THE SOCIAL STRATEGY PLAYBOOK

Build a content strategy you'll actually use — the self-guided framework behind The Social Suite.

For founders and thought leaders who know they need to show up online — and finally want a repeatable system for it. The exact content strategy framework behind The Social Suite, documented for self-study.

HOW TO USE THIS

This isn't a content calendar. It's a strategy system.

Most content advice tells you **what** to post. This playbook tells you **why** — and builds the infrastructure around that why so you're never staring at a blank screen again.

The Social Suite is my done-for-you content strategy service. This playbook is the self-guided version: the same method, documented step by step, designed for the person who wants to run the process themselves.

Work through it in order. Don't skip Part 1. The content pillars are the foundation — everything else builds on them. If you try to jump to the 30-day sprint without knowing your pillars, you'll produce content that looks fine but doesn't *work*.

"Strategy is deciding what you're willing to say no to. Content strategy is the same thing."

WHAT'S INSIDE

- Part 1: Content Pillar Framework — what to say and why it builds authority
- Part 2: Brand Voice Calibration — how to show up on Instagram, LinkedIn, and TikTok without sounding like three different people
- Part 3: The 30-Day Content Sprint — a structured system for showing up consistently
- Part 4: Templates — captions, hooks, post structures, and a posting system that doesn't depend on inspiration

BEFORE YOU START

Set aside 90 minutes to work through Parts 1 and 2. You'll need a notes doc open and a willingness to be honest about what you actually want to be known for. The rest of the playbook follows from that clarity.

WHAT YOU STAND FOR

Content pillars are the 3–5 topics you return to consistently. They're how you become known for something.

Most people post randomly and wonder why their audience doesn't grow. The answer is almost always the same: there's no through-line. No reason for someone to follow you beyond what you just posted.

Content pillars fix that. They create a coherent identity in the feed — and they make content creation dramatically easier because you're never deciding *what* to post, only *which pillar* you're drawing from today.

THE THREE TYPES OF PILLARS

AUTHORITY	PERSPECTIVE	STORY
What you know	What you believe	Who you are
Your professional expertise. The thing people should hire you for. This builds credibility and positions you as the go-to.	Your point of view on your industry. Hot takes, contrarian positions, things you'd say on stage. This builds loyalty.	Behind the work. Values, process, life. This builds trust and makes you a person, not just a service provider.

Every strong content strategy has at least one pillar from each type. You don't need to post equally across all three — but you need all three represented over time.

IDENTIFYING YOUR PILLARS

Start here: **What are the three questions people should come to you to answer?** Not the questions they do ask — the questions they should. These become your authority pillars.

Then: **What do most people in your industry get wrong?** Your answer becomes a perspective pillar.

Finally: **What's the behind-the-scenes of your work that would genuinely surprise people?** That's your story pillar.

PILLAR IDENTIFICATION WORKSHEET

Your Three Core Pillars

Write a one-sentence definition for each pillar. The test: could you name 10 posts you could make from this pillar today?

PILLAR 1 — AUTHORITY (WHAT YOU KNOW)

Example: "The real cost breakdown behind launching a website — what agencies don't tell you"

PILLAR 2 — PERSPECTIVE (WHAT YOU BELIEVE)

Example: "Most founders don't have a visibility problem — they have a clarity problem"

PILLAR 3 — STORY (WHO YOU ARE)

Example: "What building a business actually looks like when you're doing it without a roadmap"

PILLAR RATIO

A useful starting ratio: **50% Authority · 30% Perspective · 20% Story**. This positions you as the expert while making you human. Adjust as you find what resonates — but don't drop below 20% on any type for more than two weeks running.

The test for a good pillar: you should be able to name 10 posts from it in under five minutes. If you can't, the pillar is too broad or too vague.

WHAT PILLARS ARE NOT

Pillars are not topics. "Marketing" is not a pillar — it's a category. "Why most small business marketing fails before it starts" is a pillar. The difference is specificity and point of view. Bland pillars produce bland content. Sharp pillars produce content that gets saved and shared.

HOW YOU SOUND

Your voice is the same everywhere. The format changes. The tone adapts. The voice stays.

The biggest mistake founders make on social is treating each platform as a separate identity. They're professional on LinkedIn, casual on Instagram, and trying to be "authentic" on TikTok — and none of it feels like the same person.

Brand voice isn't about picking an adjective list. It's about having a clear enough point of view that it comes through no matter the format.

DEFINE YOUR THROUGH-LINE FIRST

Your Core Voice Statement

Complete this sentence: "I want people to feel _____ after consuming my content, because I believe _____."

I WANT PEOPLE TO FEEL...

BECAUSE I BELIEVE...

That statement is your filter. Every piece of content you create should pass through it. If a post doesn't make someone feel that thing or reinforce that belief — it's off-brand, even if it performs.

PLATFORM CALIBRATION

Instagram

Instagram is a visual-first platform where the image earns the stop and the caption earns the follow. Your voice here should be **intimate and considered** — like

talking to one person, not broadcasting to a crowd.

CAPTION STRUCTURE

- Line 1: The hook (make it impossible to scroll past)
- Lines 2–5: The story or the point
- Line 6–7: The pull — what they should take away
- Line 8: CTA (save this, share this, tell me)

VOICE NOTES

- Short sentences. White space is your friend.
- First-person, present tense
- No jargon — clarity over credential-signaling
- End with a question or an invitation

LinkedIn

LinkedIn rewards expertise and **professional storytelling**. The algorithm favors posts that get comments — so write in a way that opens a conversation, not closes one.

POST STRUCTURE

- Line 1: A bold, specific claim
- Lines 2–8: Three points or one story
- The turn: what this means for the reader
- Close: one direct question

VOICE NOTES

- More formal than Instagram, less formal than you think
- Data or named experience as credibility anchors
- Avoid empty affirmations — be specific
- Use line breaks aggressively for readability

TikTok

TikTok is hook-first, always. The first 2 seconds determine everything. Your voice here should be **direct and unpolished-in-a-deliberate-way** — production value is less important than clarity and energy.

VIDEO STRUCTURE

- 0–2s: The hook (state the value immediately)
- 3–15s: The setup or problem
- 15–45s: The content / the answer
- Last 5s: CTA (follow, save, part 2)

VOICE NOTES

- Talk to the camera like a person, not a presenter
- Speed is energy — don't be slow
- Controversial-but-true performs best
- Captions matter — not everyone watches with sound

THE PLATFORM TRANSLATION TEST

Take one idea from your content pillars. Write it as an Instagram caption, a LinkedIn post, and a TikTok hook. If all three feel like the same person said them — just in different contexts — your voice is calibrated. If they feel like three different brands, go back to your core voice statement.

Translation Exercise

Pick one idea from your pillars. Write it for each platform below.

THE CORE IDEA:

INSTAGRAM CAPTION HOOK (FIRST LINE ONLY):

LINKEDIN OPENING LINE:

TIKTOK 2-SECOND HOOK (WHAT YOU'D SAY OUT LOUD FIRST):

THE SYSTEM

Consistency isn't a personality trait. It's a system. This is the system.

The sprint is designed to get you from zero to a functioning content rhythm in 30 days. Not perfect content — *consistent* content. Perfect content that never ships is worth nothing.

Each week has a focus. Work the focus, not the perfection.

BEFORE YOU START: THE AUDIT (DAY 0)

Before Week 1, spend 20 minutes doing a quick audit. Pull up your current profiles and answer honestly:

- Does my bio clearly state who I help and how?
- Does my last 9 posts reflect my pillars?
- Is there a consistent visual identity?
- What post got the most engagement — and why?

Don't fix everything. Just note it. The sprint will address most of it naturally.

WEEK 1 · FOUNDATION

Set the stage

- Finalize your 3 pillars
- Rewrite your bio on each active platform
- Plan 12 posts (4 per pillar)
- Write and schedule the first 4
- Engage: 15 min/day responding to others in your space

WEEK 2 · CREATION

Build the bank

- Batch-create 8 pieces of content in one session
- Use the caption structure from Part 2
- Schedule them across the week
- Note what you find easiest to write — that's signal
- Engage: 15 min/day, focus on comments

WEEK 3 · MOMENTUM

Publish and listen

- Post daily (or your target cadence)
- Reply to every comment within 2 hours
- Reshare one piece on a second platform

WEEK 4 · REVIEW

Iterate and lock in

- Review analytics: reach, saves, new follows
- Identify which pillar performed best
- Double down on that format or angle next month

- Identify your top-performing post so far
- Write a follow-up or expansion of that post

- Build your Month 2 content plan
- Set your sustainable weekly posting target

DAILY CONTENT CALENDAR — 30 DAYS

A = Authority · P = Perspective · S = Story · R = Repurpose/Engage

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
WK 1	A Bio rewrite + intro post	P Your controversial take	A How-to or framework	S Behind the work	A FAQ you always answer	R Engage + reshare	Rest / plan
WK 2	P What others get wrong	A Mini case study	S Why you started	A Step-by-step tip	P Industry myth-bust	R Repurpose top post	Rest / batch
WK 3	A Lesson learned	S A real moment	P Unpopular truth	A Resource or tool you use	S What's working now	R Engage · thank followers	Rest / review
WK 4	A Your signature framework	P What I'd do differently	S Month-end reflection	A Top question answered	P What's next / teaser	R Analytics review	Plan Month 2

The goal of the sprint is not 30 perfect posts. It's learning what resonates for your specific audience and building a habit. Imperfect content that ships is always worth more than perfect content that doesn't.

THE TOOLKIT

*Use these when you're blank. Adapt them until they sound like you.
Then throw them away.*

TIKTOK & REEL HOOK FORMULAS

HOOK TYPE	FORMULA	EXAMPLE
The Myth-Bust	[Common belief] is a lie. Here's what's actually true.	"Posting every day is a lie. Here's what actually grows your account."
The Number	[Number] things [audience] doesn't know about [topic].	"3 things founders don't know about personal branding until it's too late."
The Warning	If you're doing [X], stop. Here's why.	"If you're posting without a content strategy, stop. Here's why it's hurting you."
The POV	POV: You finally [desirable outcome].	"POV: You finally have a content strategy that doesn't make you want to quit."
The Result	I [did X] for [time period]. Here's what happened.	"I posted every day for 90 days. Here's what actually changed."
The Direct Ask	Watch this if you [situation].	"Watch this if you're a founder who hates creating content but knows you have to."

INSTAGRAM CAPTION TEMPLATES

Template A — The Teaching Post

[Bold, specific claim as first line]
Here's what most people miss:
— [Point 1]
— [Point 2]
— [Point 3]
The thing is, [insight that connects the points].
[One sentence summary of the takeaway].

Save this if it helped. And tell me — [question that invites response].

Template B — The Story Post

[Set the scene — one specific moment, not a summary]

[What happened / what you were thinking]

[The turn — what changed or what you realized]

[What this means for your audience — bridge from your story to their life]

[CTA — question, invitation, or next step]

Template C — The Perspective Post

Controversial take: [your position in one direct sentence]

[Acknowledge the common counterargument]

But here's what I've actually seen: [evidence, example, or observation]

[Your conclusion — land the argument]

Agree? Disagree? [Invite the conversation]

LINKEDIN POST STRUCTURES

THE INSIGHT POST

[Bold claim — one sentence]

Here's why:

1. [Reason with brief explanation]
2. [Reason with brief explanation]
3. [Reason with brief explanation]

The bottom line: [one-sentence summary]

What's your experience with this?

THE STORY POST

[Specific moment that led to the insight]

[What happened — keep it tight]

[What you learned]

This changed how I [relevant professional action].

[Question for the audience]

THE POSTING SYSTEM

Inspiration is not a posting strategy. Here's the actual system:

- 1 Batch once a week. Set 60–90 minutes on one day to write the week's content.
Don't create day-to-day.

- 2 Keep an idea file. When something sparks — a client question, a frustration, something you explained well in an email — add it to a running note. This is your content inventory.
- 3 Use your pillars as constraints. When you sit down to batch, pick one from each pillar. Three posts, three directions. Done.
- 4 Schedule, don't post live. Use Later, Buffer, or even Meta's native scheduler. Live posting creates unnecessary pressure and inconsistency.
- 5 Engagement is non-negotiable. Spend 15 minutes after posting responding to comments and engaging with other accounts in your space. The algorithm rewards it. More importantly, it builds real relationships.

The two questions that make every piece of content better: "So what?" and "Who specifically is this for?" Answer both before you publish anything.

GO BUILD

The strategy is only as good as the work you put behind it. You have everything you need. Now show up.

♥ — MK PARRISH

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